APPROVED ON APRIL 8, 2026
BY THE BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS
AT THE WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION

WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION – April 1, 2026
9:00am. – Anne Basker Auditorium
600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Present: Ron Smith, Chair-Commissioner; Colene Martin, Vice-Chair-Commissioner and Gary Richardson, Commissioner, Nikole Guzman, Recorder

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These are meeting minutes only. Only text enclosed in quotation marks reports a speaker's exact words.

Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m. followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.

Items discussed were as follows:

1. **CALL MEETING TO ORDER:** Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m.

2. **DECLARE A POTENTIAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST:**
The commissioners reserved their right to declare a potential conflict of interest. There are none.

3. **Public Hearing: Order No. 2026-019; In the Matter of Uniform Procedure for Setting Fees Charged by County: Community Development (Planning) Various Fees**

Commissioner Smith opened the public hearing at 9:02 a.m.

Ruth Nelson, Finance Director, presented the item and explained that the proposed fees had been publicly posted in advance and, if adopted, would take effect May 1, 2026. She noted that the fees were developed in coordination with Community Development staff and are intended to support implementation and administration of the new ordinance.

The Board confirmed that prior discussion had taken place regarding the proposed fee structure and opened the hearing for public comment.

Commissioner Smith opened the floor to Public Testimony: (Each person given Three (3) Minutes to speak):
Simon Hare, Grants Pass, expressed concern regarding the impact of increasing fees, particularly in the context of housing affordability and broader economic conditions. Mr. Hare also requested greater transparency and suggested that a more detailed presentation of the fee schedule would be beneficial for public understanding.

Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve Board Oder 2026-019; In the Matter of Uniform Procedure for Setting Fees Charged by County: Community Development (Planning) Various Fees, Seconded by Commissioner Richardson. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0

Public Hearing closed at 9:05 a.m.

4. **ADMINISTRATIVE ACTION(S) IN CONSIDERATION OF:**

a. **Board Order No. 2026-012; In the Matter of the Transfer of County Real Property to the City of Cave Junction, Oregon**

Helen Lulich, Josephine County Property Manager, presented a Board Order for the transfer of County-owned property to the City of Cave Junction. She explained that the property had been acquired through tax foreclosure and was previously offered for auction. However, the City of Cave Junction identified the parcel as a retention pond serving an existing commercial development and requested transfer of ownership to properly operate and maintain the infrastructure. Ms. Lulich noted that the transfer would correct the ownership status of the property and ensure continued maintenance consistent with its intended function.

b. **210 Tacoma Final Plat Property Line Adjustment**

Helene Lulich, Josephine County Property Manager, presented the final plat associated with a lot line adjustment for the 210 Tacoma property. She provided historical context, explaining that the property was originally part of a larger 80-acre parcel acquired for airport-related purposes and later rezoned to commercial light industrial.
She explained that the Board had previously directed staff to pursue sale of the building and a portion of the property rather than the full acreage, necessitating a lot line adjustment. The resulting parcel consists of approximately 7.44 acres and includes the existing building, water infrastructure, and associated improvements, along with shared access easements. Ms. Lulich reported that the project was completed under budget and that associated costs will be reimbursed to the property reserve fund upon closing of the sale, which is anticipated on or before May 1, 2026.

c. Resolution No. 2026-004; Josephine County Supplemental Budget for Fiscal Year 2025-2026

Ruth Nelson, Finance Director, presented the second supplemental budget for fiscal year 2025–2026. She explained that supplemental budgets are required to legally amend the adopted budget and reflect changes in appropriations or funding allocations. Ms. Nelson outlined that the proposed changes include adjustments within multiple departments, including FireWise, Planning, Facilities, and Human Resources. She noted that most of the adjustments represent reallocation of existing funds rather than an increase in total budget authority, with only a modest overall increase. She further provided an update on the FireWise grant, confirming that an extension had been granted through December 2026, allowing the County to continue program implementation and staffing efforts. She emphasized that approval of the supplemental budget is necessary to enable those activities. Discussion included clarification of prior Budget Committee actions. It was noted that while multiple requests had been presented to the Budget Committee, only the FireWise-related request received sufficient affirmative votes for approval due to statutory voting requirements. Ms. Nelson clarified that the Board retains authority to adopt the supplemental budget and make adjustments as needed.

5. **REQUESTS/COMMENTS FROM CITIZENS:** *(Each person will be given three (3) minutes to speak)*
Victor, Grants Pass, spoke in opposition of Trent Carpenter to the Solid Waste discussion at yesterday's General Discussion meeting.
Dutch Kaswell, Grants Pass, spoke on Josephine County Property off West Picket and lack of Code Enforcement with issues of homelessness – Exhibit 1
Dave Roselyn, Grants Pass, spoke about lack of code enforcement for over a year.
Chaz Rogers, Williams, spoke about desire to purchase Pipe Fork for recreational purposes.
Cheryl Brewner, Williams, spoke about a desire to purchase Pipe Fork for recreational purposes.
Konnor Kirkpatrick, Josephine County, spoke on the Solid Waste mitigation and a draft contract sent to the board.
Judy Aherns, Josephine County, spoke on community to come together and Easter celebrations.
Matt Spurlock, Grants Pass, spoke about transparency with press releases and Code Enforcement.
Mark Jones, Josephine County, spoke about transparency and the PIO position.
Habib Shakerie, Josephine County, spoke in favor of the current Board of Commissioners.
Simon Hare, Josephine County, spoke in opposition of the Letter regarding his contract with the County.

6. **BOARD MAY REVIEW PUBLIC COMMENTS/QUESTIONS:**
The Board addressed public comments

Board Discussion and Action – Agenda Item 4(a)
Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve Board Order No. 2026-012; In the Matter of the Transfer of County Real Property to the City of Cave Junction, Oregon, Seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0

Board Discussion and Action – Agenda Item 4(b)

Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve 210 Tacoma Final Plat Property Line Adjustment, Seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0

Board Discussion and Action – Agenda Item 4(c)
Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve Resolution No. 2026-004; Josephine County Supplemental Budget for Fiscal Year 2025-2026, Seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0

7. **APPROVAL OF CONSENT CALENDAR:**
   a. **Minutes** *(Draft minutes are available for viewing in the Board's Office)*
   Kajo Radio Interview – March 24, 2026
   City/County Monthly Update – March 24, 2026
   Admin Workshop – March 24, 2026
   Weekly Business Session – March 25, 2026
   Budget Workshop Meeting – March 25, 2026
   Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve the Consent Calendar, seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

8. **OTHER: (ORS 192.640(1))** *". . . notice shall include a list of the principal subjects anticipated to be considered at the meeting, but this requirement shall not limit the ability of a governing body to consider additional subjects.")*
   None

9. **ANNOUNCEMENTS: MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS:**

   Commissioner Martin wished the public a Happy Easter and Commissioner Smith cautioned fire season.

Weekly Business Session adjourned at 9:40 a.m.

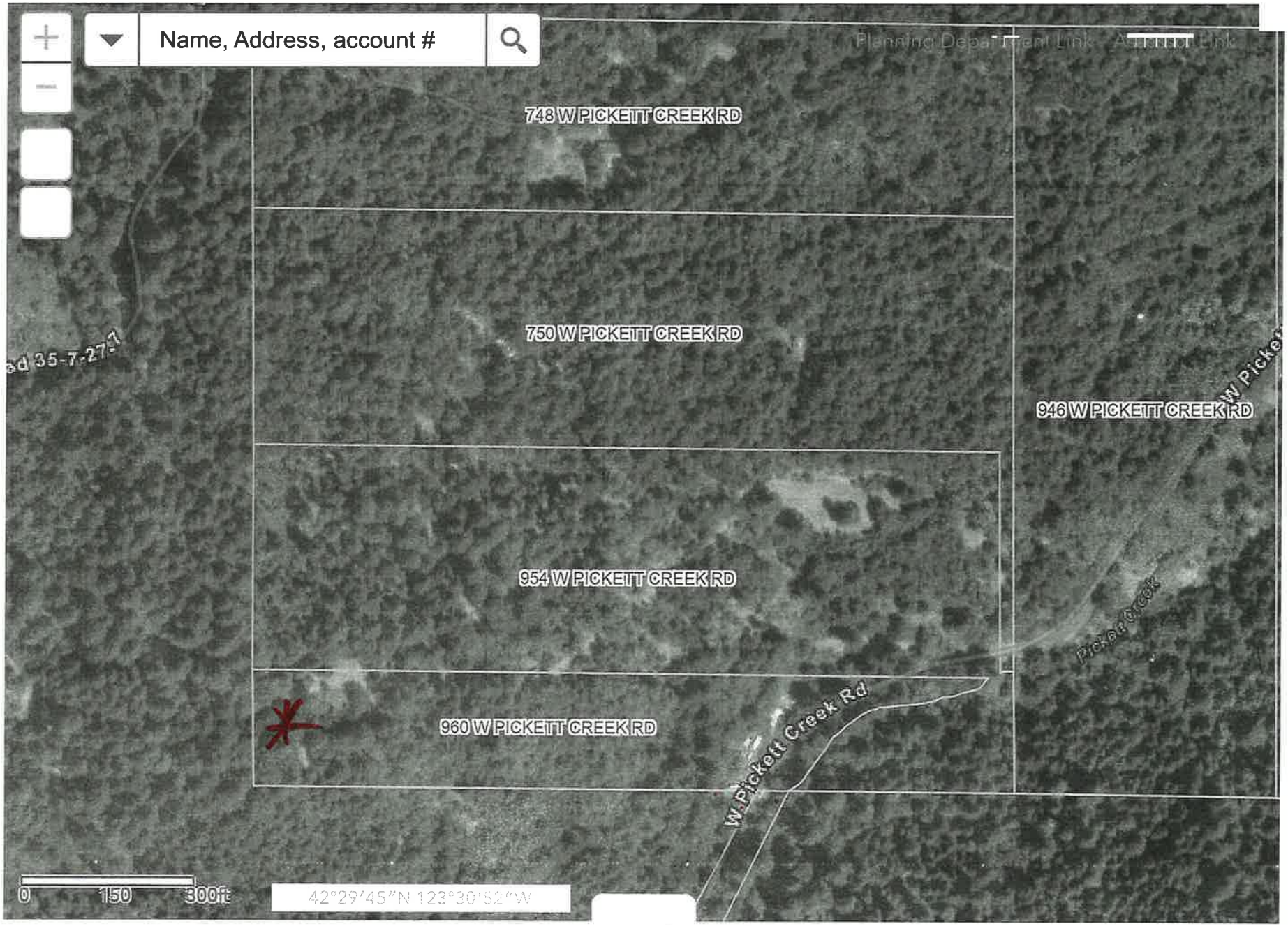
Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Exhibit 1- W. Pickett Creek Road

Weekly Business Session
April 1, 2026
Exhibit 1

Josephine County Property Data Map

Josephine County, Oregon



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JOSEPHINE COUNTY PROPERTY ASSESSMENT & TAX DATA

Property	Owner	Property Address	2026 In Process Real Market Value
R306286	THOMSON, JOHN C & THOMSON, NATACHA	960 W PICKETT CREEK RD, GRANTS PASS, OR 97527	$101,330

Property Page: Property Details

2026 GENERAL INFORMATION

Property Status	A Active
Property Type	Residential
Legal Description	ACRES 4.87, POTENTIAL ADD'L TAX LIAB
Alternate Account Number	-
Neighborhood	1100 Riverbanks Rd
Map Number	35-07-27-00-000700-00
Property Use	641-Forestland By Application; Improved
Levy Code Area	05
Zoning	WR

RELATED PROPERTIES

Linked Properties -

2026 OWNER INFORMATION

Owner Name	THOMSON, JOHN C & THOMSON, NATACHA
Mailing Address	1250 CENTRAL AVE UNIT K3 WENATCHEE, WA 98801

2026 IMPROVEMENTS

Expand/Collapse All

Improvement #1	Improvement Type	Beds
⊞ -	Misc Imp	0

2026 LAND SEGMENTS

STATE CODE	SEGMENT TYPE	LAND SIZE
L1	OSD On-Site Development	-
L2	641 Forest-Designated by Appl-Improved	3.87 Acres
L3	401 Tract; Residential; Improved	1.00 Acres
TOTALS		**212137.20 Sq. ft / 4.87 acres**

CERTIFIED / IN PROCESS VALUES

YEAR	IMPROVEMENTS	LAND	RMV	SPECIAL USE	ASSESSED VALUE
2026 (In Process)	$3,920	$97,410	$101,330	$900	$59,270
2025	$4,230	$100,340	$104,570	$900	$57,570

SALES HISTORY

SALE DATE	SELLER	BUYER	INST #	SALE PRICE	INST TYPE
7/29/2008	ROCKLAGE, LAURA G	THOMSON, JOHN C & THOMSON, NATACHA	08-011981	$60,000	Warranty Deed
	HIGGINS, ROBERT	ROCKLAGE, LAURA G	07-014472	-	Deeds

TOTAL TAXES DUE	
Current Year Due	$509.34
Past Years Due	$1,347.72
Total Due	$1,857.06

- This property has remaining taxes due from a prior year
- SEE MESSAGE ON EVENTS PLS
- If applicable, the described property is receiving special valuation based upon its use. Additional rollback taxes which may become due based on the provisions of the special valuation are not indicated in this listing.

TAX SUMMARY

Effective Date: 3/30/2026 Details

TAXYEAR	TOTAL BILLED	AD VALOREM	SPECIAL ASMT	PRINCIPAL	INTEREST	DATE PAID	TOTAL OWED
2025	$496.11	$417.49	$78.62	$496.11	$13.23	-	$509.34
2024	$471.66	$405.41	$66.25	$471.66	$85.95	-	$557.61
2023	$406.58	$339.99	$66.59	$406.58	$139.14	-	$545.72
2022	$399.06	$332.81	$66.25	$399.06	$78.65	-	$244.39
2021	$387.54	$321.29	$66.25	$387.54	$0.00	-	$0.00
2020	$401.74	$335.49	$66.25	$401.74	$0.00	-	$0.00
2019	$387.98	$321.73	$66.25	$387.98	$0.00	-	$0.00
2018	$382.53	$316.28	$66.25	$382.53	$0.00	-	$0.00
2017	$382.51	$316.26	$66.25	$382.51	$0.00	-	$0.00
2016	$332.69	$266.44	$66.25	$332.69	$0.00	-	$0.00
2015	$323.13	$256.88	$66.25	$323.13	$0.00	-	$0.00
2014	$316.31	$250.06	$66.25	$316.31	$0.00	-	$0.00
2013	$306.40	$0.00	$0	$306.40	$0.00	-	$0.00
2012	$299.84	$0.00	$0	$299.84	$0.00	-	$0.00
2011	$291.50	$0.00	$0	$291.50	$0.00	-	$0.00
2010	$286.88	$0.00	$0	$286.88	$0.00	-	$0.00
2009	$280.40	$0.00	$0	$280.40	$0.00	-	$0.00
2008	$300.90	$0.00	$0	$300.90	$0.00	-	$0.00
2007	$259.85	$0.00	$0	$259.85	$0.00	-	$0.00
2006	$255.22	$0.00	$0	$255.22	$0.00	-	$0.00
2005	$359.87	$0.00	$0	$359.87	$0.00	-	$0.00
2004	$21.78	$0.00	$0	$21.78	$0.00	-	$0.00
2003	$18.24	$0.00	$0	$18.24	$0.00	-	$0.00
2002	$18.25	$0.00	$0	$18.25	$0.00	-	$0.00
2001	$18.25	$0.00	$0	$18.25	$0.00	-	$0.00
2000	$15.24	$0.00	$0	$15.24	$0.00	-	$0.00
1999	$18.23	$0.00	$0	$18.23	$0.00	-	$0.00
1998	$18.20	$0.00	$0	$18.20	$0.00	-	$0.00
1997	$18.20	$0.00	$0	$18.20	$0.00	-	$0.00
1996	$18.28	$0.00	$0	$18.28	$0.00	-	$0.00

PROPERTY FEES

TAXYEAR	FEE TYPE	TOTAL BILLED	DATE PAID	TOTAL OWED
2021	PUBLISH FEE	$104.91	12-29-2025	$0.00
2021	FORECLOSURE FEE	$200.00	12-29-2025	$0.00

TAXYEAR	RECEIPT NUMBER	TRANSACTION DATE	PAYMENT AMOUNT
2022	JOCO-244150	12-29-2025	$3,400.00
2017	1104640	5-10-2018	$797.04
2015	1003231	1-11-2016	$326.00
2014	963680	7-6-2015	$337.40
2013	910360	3-25-2014	$1,064.27
2010	740651	11-15-2010	$278.27
2009	666450	10-30-2009	$271.99
2008	639832	11-18-2008	$291.87
2007	590560	11-19-2007	$686.63
2005	497257	2-10-2006	$119.96
2005	471441	11-10-2005	$119.96
2004	414888	11-8-2004	$21.13
2003	360351	11-3-2003	$17.69
2002	308985	10-28-2002	$17.70
2001	255824	11-5-2001	$17.70
2000	201170	10-26-2000	$14.78
1999	151007	11-1-1999	$17.68
1998	110983	11-9-1998	$17.65
1997	57557	12-8-1997	$17.65
1996	41149	1-1-1938	$18.28